October 2026 Feature Guide — Part 3

Smart Club Platform · what's new, who it's for, and how each feature works

Everything in this guide is built, reviewed and fully tested, and goes live with the next deployment. It is a companion to the October guides published on 6 and 8 October; nothing here repeats those. Features are grouped by who uses them. The biggest change — registration windows — affects everyone, so it comes first.

1. Registration windows now close everything (all roles)

Until now, a union's transfer window only limited **transfers between clubs** — a brand-new player could still register at any time of year, and several back-office routes ignored the window entirely. That is gone. When a union's window is closed, **no player can be registered or transferred at all**, by anyone, anywhere on the platform. Unions that have never set up windows are not affected — for them, registration stays open all year.

What each person sees while the window is closed:

- **A player opening a club's registration link** sees a clear full-page notice: registration is closed, here is the next window and its dates. There is no form to fill in, and nothing they type or upload is kept. Previously the form stayed open and a transfer attempt was recorded as an automatically rejected request — that no longer happens; nothing is recorded at all.
- **A club chair** sees the same closed notice at the top of every player-registration screen in the portal (single player, quick-add and roster upload), with the register buttons switched off — so nobody fills in a whole form only to be refused at the end. The button to issue a transfer to another club is switched off too.
- **A union admin** sees a “Registration closed” banner in the transfers area. Approving or overriding a transfer is switched off until the window opens — the tooltip says why. Rejecting a request, reallocating it to the right club, and reopening a rejected one still work, so the queue can be tidied at any time. A reopened request is marked “Parked — completes when the window opens” so it is clear why it is waiting.
- **Reminder messages to clubs** about unanswered transfer requests pause while the window is closed (there is nothing the club could do), and resume when it opens. The admin team's weekly summary keeps arriving so nothing is forgotten.

Why this changed: *the union asked for the window to mean what it says: outside the window, no registrations of any kind. The window dates themselves are managed by the platform team, so if something genuinely must happen mid-closure, the fix is to adjust the window — a deliberate, visible act — rather than a hidden back door.*

2. For union administrators (admin console)

2.1 Scorers now show on every fixture

Appointing a scorer always saved correctly, but the series editor's fixture table only showed umpires — so a saved scorer looked like it had vanished. The Umpires column is now **Officials**: every fixture shows its umpires on one line and its scorers (scorer and backup) on the next, each with its own appoint button. Appointments made in the weekly Fixtures Hub and in the series editor are the same data — change them in either place.

- Adding a brand-new scorer now asks for an optional phone or email on the spot. That matters because appointment notices go out automatically — a scorer with no contact details would silently never get one. If a chosen scorer has no contacts, the picker says so.

- The small “Notified” tick that umpire appointments carry now appears for scorers too.

2.2 Upload compliance documents on a club's behalf

Clubs sometimes hand their paperwork to the union on paper, by email or over WhatsApp. Admins can now file those documents directly on the club's page in the console — no more asking the club to upload something the union already has in hand.

- Each document row has an **Upload** button (or **Replace** when a file is already there). Multi-file documents such as safeguarding certificates have **Add file** and a per-file **Remove** — removing always asks for confirmation first.
- The club sees the document in its own portal immediately, exactly as if it had uploaded it.
- The record keeps track of the fact that the union uploaded the file, for the audit trail.

3. For umpires (and the people who message them)

3.1 Appointment notices name your fellow umpire

When a fixture has two umpires appointed, each umpire's appointment notice — email and WhatsApp alike — now names the other umpire, alongside the fixture, date, time and venue it already carried. Standing umpires can coordinate travel and arrival without asking the union who the second official is. Notices to referees and scorers are unchanged.

4. For the platform team (operator portal)

- The transfer-windows card on a tenant's page now says plainly that windows close **all** registration, not just transfers — the saved windows themselves work exactly as before.
- The weekly roster intake refuses to add players for a union whose window is closed, with a message naming the window. The command-line import tools refuse in the same way, and the old override switch has been removed: adjust the union's windows instead.